

Customer Lifecycle Testing

How I test Corstead from an operator user point of view

When I test Corstead, I go through the customer lifecycle from beginning to end as if I am the person operating the software for my company. The goal is to make sure the software is easy to use, efficient, requires fewer clicks, does not make me enter the same information twice, and gives the office, field crew and customer a fluid experience from one step to the next.

This is the main lifecycle I want working correctly first. I will test several other prospect and customer scenarios later, but this is the basic path everything else should build from.

MAIN TEST PATH

01 Create Prospect OFFICE	02 Schedule Estimate OFFICE	03 Finalize Estimate OFFICE
04 Prospect Accepts PROSPECT	05 Convert + Create Job OFFICE	06 Crew Executes Job CREW
07 Create + Send Invoice OFFICE / CUSTOMER	08 Record Payment OFFICE / CUSTOMER	09 Final Record Review OFFICE

Prospect -> Estimate -> Accepted -> Office Conversion + Job -> Crew -> Invoice -> Payment -> Complete

What I am looking for throughout the test

The next action should be obvious. Information should carry forward automatically when it already exists. I should not have to leave the workflow, hunt for the next screen, or re-enter customer, estimate, job or billing information that Corstead already has.

01	Create the Prospect OFFICE
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I start by pretending that a new person has contacted the company and is asking for service. That person begins as a prospect, not a customer.

- Open the Prospect area and create a new prospect profile.
- Enter the basic information I would normally collect: name, phone number, email, service address and general notes about the work they are asking about.
- Save the profile and reopen it to make sure the information is stored correctly and is easy to edit.

- Keep using this same prospect record through the rest of the lifecycle instead of creating unrelated records later.

What I check: The record clearly starts as a prospect. Adding the person should be fast, the fields should be easy to understand, and the information should be easy to find later. I should not have to enter the same contact information again when I move into the estimate process.

02

Schedule and Assign the Estimate | OFFICE

From the prospect profile, I schedule the estimate and identify the employee who is responsible for it.

- Choose the estimate date and time from the prospect profile.
- Assign the estimate to the employee who will handle it.
- Confirm that the estimate appears where I expect it to appear on the calendar or assigned employee view.
- Make sure the prospect name, service address, contact information and estimate appointment all stay connected.

What I check: Scheduling the estimate should be straightforward and should not require me to leave the prospect workflow unnecessarily. The office should be able to see who is assigned, and the assigned employee should be able to find the estimate and the information needed to handle it.

03

Finalize and Send the Estimate | OFFICE

I then build the estimate, review it as the office user, and review what the prospect will actually receive.

- Open the estimate attached to the prospect profile.
- Enter the services, line items, pricing and any relevant notes.
- Finalize the estimate so it is ready to send.
- Review the customer-facing estimate, not only the office editing screen.
- Confirm the prospect has a clear way to approve, decline or respond to the estimate.
- Make sure the estimate is still saved and easy to find from the prospect profile.

What I check: The estimate should be easy for the office to create and easy for the prospect to understand. The service descriptions, prices and response options should be clear. The office should also be able to tell whether the estimate is still being prepared, has been sent, or has received a response.

04

Prospect Accepts the Estimate | PROSPECT

For this primary test scenario, I assume the prospect accepts the estimate.

- View the estimate from the prospect/customer-facing side and accept it.

- If the estimate contains optional or selectable services, approve only the work that the prospect is actually purchasing.
- Return to the office view and confirm that the system clearly shows the estimate as accepted.
- Confirm that approved work can be distinguished from anything declined or left unselected.
- The system should flag or notify the office that the prospect has accepted. Acceptance should not automatically convert the prospect into a customer.

What I check: The office should immediately understand that action is required. The accepted estimate and the exact work approved should be clear before anyone converts the prospect or creates the job.

05

Office Converts the Prospect to a Customer and Creates the Job | OFFICE

This is the handoff point. The system tells the office that the estimate was accepted, but the office controls when the prospect becomes a customer and when the job is created.

- An office user opens the accepted prospect profile.
- The office manually chooses to convert that prospect into a customer.
- As part of that process, the office creates the job from the work the prospect approved.
- The job should use the approved services, line items and agreed pricing from the estimate. Work that was not approved should not automatically become part of the job.
- The office sets the service date and time and assigns the job to the appropriate crew or individual employee.
- Once the conversion is completed, the prospect profile should no longer remain as an active prospect record. The information moves from the prospect database into the customer database.
- The new customer profile should contain the same name, contact information, service address, notes and other information already collected during the prospect process.
- The original accepted estimate should remain saved on the customer profile and be easy to find later.
- The new scheduled job should be attached to the customer profile and appear on the calendar.

Prospect record	No longer exists as an active prospect after conversion.
Customer profile	Contains the prospect information that was already collected.
Accepted estimate	Remains saved in the customer history.
Job	Created from approved work, scheduled, assigned and linked to the customer.

What I check: This should feel like one connected handoff, not a rebuild. The office makes the decision to convert the prospect and create the job, but Corstead should carry the information forward. There should not be a duplicate prospect and customer, a second copy of the estimate, or a need to retype approved work.

Crew assignment

A crew does not require a permanent or default Crew Leader. Admins and Managers should be able to add or remove employees and move people between crews as needed. A crew could be two Technicians, a Crew Leader and a Technician, or another combination. The Crew Leader role is a permission level, not a requirement for forming a crew.

Schedule-change messages

If the company has schedule notifications enabled, scheduling or moving a job should not automatically send a text or email. The user should be prompted, review the message and confirm whether to send it.

06**Assigned Crew Reviews and Executes the Job** | CREW

Once the job is scheduled and assigned, I switch from the office view to the field employee view and test the job at the crew level.

- Log in as an employee who is assigned to the job.
- Open that employee's schedule or calendar and find the job.
- Confirm the crew can see the service date and time, service address, approved work, relevant job notes and the information needed to perform the work.
- Assigned Crew Leaders and Technicians should be able to see the customer contact information needed for the job, including the customer name, phone number, email and service address.
- Pricing visibility should follow the permissions set by the Admin. The employee should only see pricing that the company has chosen to allow that role or user to see.
- Hypothetically perform the service and use the field workflow to mark the job complete.
- Return to the office view and confirm that the completed status is reflected there and the job is ready for invoicing.

What I check: The assigned crew should have everything necessary to execute its work without needing broad access to the full customer database or office-only areas. The crew should not have to call the office for basic information that already exists on the job. Completing the job should update the office, but it should not by itself create a payment or mark an invoice as paid.

07**Create and Send the Invoice** | OFFICE / CUSTOMER

After the job is complete, I move into billing and test both the office invoice workflow and what the customer sees.

- Create the invoice from the completed job.
- Use the customer information, completed services and agreed amounts that already exist in the system instead of re-entering them.
- Review the invoice from the office editing screen.

- Review the customer-facing version of the invoice and confirm the customer, services, amounts, total and payment instructions are clear.
- Send the invoice through the test delivery process or to a test contact.
- Open what the customer actually receives and verify that it is understandable and provides a clear path to payment.
- Return to the office view and confirm the invoice shows the correct sent/open status available in the system.

What I check: The invoice should come naturally from the completed job and remain linked to the correct customer. The office should not have to rebuild the same service information. Sending the invoice should not mark it paid.

08

Record the Customer Payment | OFFICE / CUSTOMER

I then hypothetically pay the invoice and confirm the payment is recorded against the correct customer and invoice.

- Record the amount paid and payment date.
- Record the payment method.
- Save any appropriate reference information, such as a check number when applicable.
- For the main lifecycle test, pay the invoice in full and confirm the remaining balance becomes \$0.
- Confirm the payment appears in the customer history and on the correct invoice.

Cash	Enter a cash payment and confirm the correct amount is applied.
Check	Enter the check payment and any check reference used by the company.
Credit card	Use the available test-mode payment process and confirm a successful payment updates the invoice correctly.
Gift certificate	Apply the redeemed value as a gift certificate and confirm it reduces the invoice balance correctly.

Testing note: Use one payment method per test invoice. I can repeat the lifecycle or use separate test invoices to test the other payment methods rather than applying multiple full payments to one invoice.

What I check: The amount, method, date and invoice/customer association should all be correct. A full payment should result in a \$0 balance and a paid invoice without duplicate payments or unexplained balances.

09

Review the Completed Customer Lifecycle | OFFICE

At the end of the test, I go back through the entire customer record. I want to see what everything looks like after the customer has been serviced, invoiced and paid.

Customer profile	Customer information and notes are correct. The accepted estimate, completed job, invoice and payment history are connected and easy to find.
Estimate	The original estimate remains available. Its acceptance and approved work are preserved so I can see exactly what led to the job.
Calendar	The job shows the correct service date, time and assignment. Its completion status is accurate, and any billing/payment status shown agrees with the invoice.
Job	The job is complete and still linked to the correct customer, estimate and invoice. The completed work and assignment can still be reviewed.
Invoice	The invoice reflects the work and agreed amounts, shows the recorded payment and has a \$0 remaining balance in this full-payment scenario.
Payment	The correct amount, method and date are visible and tied to the correct customer and invoice. There is no duplicate payment or unexplained balance.

What I am checking at every step

- Is the next action obvious, or do I have to search around to figure out what to do?
- Am I making unnecessary clicks or leaving the workflow when I should not have to?
- Am I re-entering information that Corstead already has?
- Does the office see the right information at the right time?
- Does the assigned crew see what it needs to do the work without seeing unrelated office information?
- Does the customer see a clear, professional estimate and invoice?
- Do changes carry through correctly from the prospect profile to the customer profile, estimate, job, calendar, invoice and payment?
- At the end, is there one clean customer record instead of duplicated or disconnected records?

How I will report problems I find

When I send screenshots, recordings or comments back to the development team, I will identify the lifecycle step, which user view I was in, the action I took, what I expected to happen and what actually happened. That should make it easier to locate the issue and verify the fix against the same lifecycle test.

FINAL RESULT FOR THIS TEST

Prospect accepted estimate. Office converted prospect to customer. Job scheduled and completed. Invoice sent and paid. Customer retained with complete history. Remaining balance: \$0.